



Risk Mitigation Case Brief

Prepared by:

Case A: Microsoft

CHOOSE 3 CASES (A, B, C, or D) AND PREPARE A BRIEF USING THE FOLLOWING AS AN EXAMPLE. REPLACE THESE INSTRUCTIONS AND THE EXAMPLE BRIEF WITH YOUR THREE BRIEFS. REMOVE THE HIGHLIGHTING.

Microsoft transitioned to the cloud. This change helped transition everyone online during COVID, when people couldn't be in person, but it also significantly increased their cybersecurity challenges. To mitigate these challenges, they implemented zero trust architecture, MFA, and regular security audits. This made the outcome favorable, reducing the incidence of data breaches and unauthorized access to Microsoft's networks and systems. If they chose a different risk management strategy, I would assume that since they have an enormous amount of money, they would transfer the liability for damages to an insurance company or somewhere else. I feel this would have been quite effective until their rates increased too much due to frequent attacks. I also see that they would quickly lose trust with people since the transference of liability only protects the company financially, not socially.

Case B: Google

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Google launched Project Zero in 2014. This project was aimed at helping secure their products as well as other security software worldwide. This project consisted of three main actions. They released bug bounty programs, which encouraged private security researchers to notify them in case there was a vulnerability in exchange for a reward. This seemed very aligned with their goal to promote security across many other security software worldwide because instead of punishing people for finding vulnerabilities, they were rewarding them (unlike Denuvo, if you know you know). They also promoted regular security reviews. This allowed them to quickly identify and remediate vulnerabilities. This worked well as it created redundancy in their software vulnerability verification, so if someone missed something one time, they still had a chance to find it later (if a bug bounty hunter doesn't find it first). They also launched a public disclosure policy, which is responsible for making sure that software vendors were made aware of vulnerabilities, allowing patches to be developed before they were disclosed to the public. This also greatly aligned with their goal of promoting security throughout platforms all over the world, since they were giving vendors a chance to patch their vulnerabilities before they could be exploited further. In the end, Project Zero was a huge success, achieving exactly what they had intended to in

the first place. If they were to choose a different approach, I feel that they could have also kept the vulnerabilities to be handled within their own company by investing more in their cybersecurity department. This would have also effectively mitigated many of the attacks; however, this would go against their goal of also promoting security around the world, and not just for Google itself.

Case D: Salesforce

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Salesforce was truly a pioneer in their field by launching the first successful cloud-based business model. This allowed businesses to manage customer information without needing on-premises hardware. This raised a problem, however, concerning data privacy and protection. Salesforce was responsible for protecting its own infrastructure, but also protecting the data of thousands of businesses that rely on its platform. This made their cybersecurity proposal a crucial component of their proposition. They made three changes to help mitigate the risk of something happening to their own or other businesses' data. First, they implemented encryption for data in transit and at rest, assuring that it would be astronomically more difficult to access the confidential data they had in their possession. Second, they implemented regular security assessments. This allowed them to periodically test for vulnerabilities in their system, making it much more likely that they would find their vulnerabilities early enough for threats to not be able to exploit them. And third, they provided customers with their own robust tools to manage their own security settings, including access controls and authentication protocols. This effectively transferred a lot of the liability for vulnerabilities to the clients and not Salesforce, since Salesforce wasn't the one managing their primary attack surfaces anymore. In the end, Salesforce's approach to cloud security has successfully and effectively protected its platform from major cybersecurity threats, ensuring long-term trust with its clients. If they were to choose a different approach, I feel that they could instead have implemented a bug bounty program and zero-trust architecture. This has the potential to more effectively stop threats not only from the outside, but also from the inside, without as large of an expenditure.